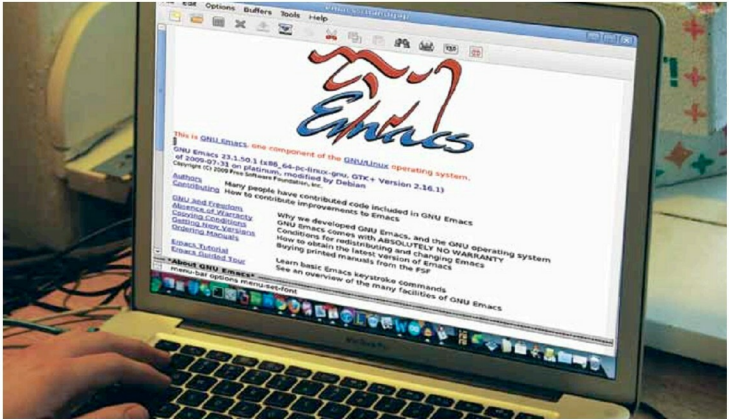


Getting Started with Haskell on Emacs

Emacs is a popular text editor that can be extended and customised. Haskell is a statically typed, functional programming language. Haskell-mode is an Emacs major mode that provides support to write and use Haskell programs. This article explains interesting features and tips on using Haskell-mode with GNU Emacs.



You can install Haskell-mode using your distribution package manager. For example, on Fedora you can use:

```
$ sudo yum install emacs-haskell-mode
```

Mode

You can enter Haskell-mode when opening a Haskell source file that has an extension `.hs`, or it can be started within Emacs using:

```
M-x haskell-mode
```

On the modeline, you will now see `‘(Haskell)’`, indicating that the Haskell mode has been activated. You can enter the indent mode using:

```
M-x haskell-indent-mode
```

The modeline will now show `‘(Haskell Ind)’`.

Interpreter

To load a Haskell source file into the interpreter, use `C-c`

`C-I`. It will create a new buffer, load the module in the current buffer and give a prompt to work with. Consider the following `Square.hs` program:

```
square :: Int -> Int
square x = x * x
```

Opening a `Square.hs` file in an Emacs buffer, and running `C-c C-I` will produce the following in a new buffer:

```
GHCi, version 7.0.4: http://www.haskell.org/ghc/ :? for help.
Loading package ghc-prim ... linking ... done.
Loading package integer-gmp ... linking ... done.
Loading package base ... linking ... done.
Prelude> :load "/home/guest/Square.hs"
[1 of 1] Compiling Main ( /home/guest/Square.hs, interpreted )
Ok, modules loaded: Main.
*Main>
```

If you have multiple buffers opened within Emacs, you can directly switch from the `(Haskell)` mode buffer to the Haskell interpreter using `C-c C-z`.